ROBERT MERRELL

Healthcare Product Executive | AI-Enabled Portfolios | Product Organization Builder

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Healthcare product executive with 26 years of professional experience, 20 in healthcare technology, leading product, data, and AI strategy across health systems, payers, life sciences, diagnostics, and digital health. Served as Head of Product and Executive Leadership Team member at Vynca and AHA, building product orgs from the ground up and owning portfolio strategy, roadmap, and commercial results. Grew Vynca from $900K to $33M in 4.5 years and led a product org of 24 product managers/directors with 400+ engineers at Invitae. Currently leads certification, education, and tech portfolio at NAHQ while building AI capability across the organization.

$33M Vynca revenue, up from $900K	**65%** Reduction in time-to-market at Vynca	**95%** AI patient-matching accuracy at Vynca	**26 Yrs** Experience with 20 yrs in healthcare technology

CORE COMPETENCIES

Executive Leadership	AI & Data Strategy	Product & GTM Strategy	Growth & Customer Success
• P&L Ownership & Financial Acumen • C-Suite, Board & Investor Relations • M&A Due Diligence & Integration • Product & Engineering Leadership	• AI/ML Strategy in Healthcare • Data Governance, SOC 2, HIPAA • EMR Integration (HL7, FHIR, Epic) • Predictive Analytics & RCM	• Vision & Portfolio Management • Go-to-Market & Commercialization • Market Research & Intelligence • MVP & Product-Led Growth	• Enterprise SaaS Sales Enablement • Customer Segmentation & Retention • Outcomes-Driven Development • Healthcare Regulatory Strategy



CAREER HISTORY

VP of Product & Portfolio Operations | NAHQ, Chicago, IL *2026 – Present*

Leading product and education portfolio strategy for NAHQ, partnering with executive leadership to align certification, education, and technology offerings with strategic alliances (e.g., Joint Commission).

- Own end-to-end product/portfolio operations across 200+ learning content pieces, 6 certifications, and 4 programs (Learning Labs, NAHQ Next conference); lead team of 13.
- Driving B2C portfolio growth alongside B2B product innovation initiatives to accelerate healthcare quality workforce capability.
  - Spearheading AI enablement across Copilot, Copilot Studio, and Claude Code to advance internal capabilities and quality outcomes.

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Director of Product Management | Lucem Health, Raleigh, NC *2024 – 2026*

Led product strategy for AI predictive analytics platforms serving health systems and life sciences, scaling early-stage startup from pre-revenue to ~$10M incremental annual revenue from market expansions.

- Expanded engineering team from 3 to 11 across 3 pod teams, plus 2 analysts and 1 PM.
- Architected direct-to-consumer and AI-driven clinical workflows achieving 60% patient adoption.

Director of Product Management | Invitae, San Francisco, CA *2023 – 2024*

Owned product strategy for billing optimization and EMR workflow automation at a $1B+ genetic information company, leading 24 product managers and directors with 400+ onshore and offshore engineers.

- Drove $200M+ in additional revenue through AI/ML test order efficiencies, automated billing workflows, and EMR optimization across major health systems.
- Built and launched Epic Aura bi-directional integrations enabling provider-centric genetic testing workflows, achieving 15% growth in health system adoption within six months.

Director of Product Management & Development (Head of Product) | Vynca, Palo Alto, CA *2018 – 2023*

Head of Product and Executive Leadership Team member for a digital health startup focused on Advance Care Planning, growing revenue from $900K to $33M in 4.5 years. Built the product organization from the ground up, with engineering growing from 10 to 23 and 3 product managers.

- Achieved a 73% digital completion rate for Advance Care Planning patient centric workflows, a leading outcome metric in the space, through user centered design and behavioral health principles.
- Delivered AI patient matching at 95% accuracy and reduced time to market by 65%.
- Launched a self-service SaaS platform that cut average customer implementation time by about 2 months, improving time to value and NPS.

Director of Product & Data (Head of Product) | American Hospital Association, Chicago, IL *2015 – 2018*

Led product, data, and analytics strategy for Health Forum ($200M AHA subsidiary serving 12,000+ hospital executives). Executive Leadership Team member managing 7 PMs, internal IT, and 4 external build teams.

- Achieved a 94% reduction in operating expenses within 6 months by consolidating data infrastructure into an integrated platform for workflow optimization and enterprise reporting.
- Delivered an enterprise data warehouse, a fully responsive reporting system, and the digital migration of flagship publications to 12,000+ health system decision-makers.

Director of Product Management & Development | Aetna – Practice iQ, Hartford, CT *2012 – 2015*

Incubated Practice iQ business unit within Aetna ($63B) to build ACO models and transition independent providers from fee-for-service to value-based reimbursement.

- Designed and scaled a multi-partner business model with Aetna Analytics, Active Health Management, CVS, and Walgreens to deliver integrated technology and consulting services.
- Reduced development expenses by 60% through offshore team transitions while expanding product capabilities.

Manager of Technology & Product Development | Accretive Health, Chicago, IL *2011 – 2012*

Managed a SaaS and services clinical recommendation platform for 200+ employed physicians and 400+ hospital clients across four product lines focused on denial reduction and billing integrity. Grew clients from 20 to 400 in under 18 months and launched three additional products generating $15M in new revenue, using agile methods across onshore and offshore teams.

Manager of Solutions Management | Allscripts (ECIN), Chicago, IL *2006 – 2011*

Drove post-merger growth of ECIN after Allscripts acquisition, scaling clients from 50 to 800+ and revenue from $3M to $120M. Launched SaaS solutions for discharge planning, UM, and CDI ($2M Year 1 revenue) with 98% client retention.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S., Information Systems Management – Keller Graduate School, Chicago, IL *2002 – 2004*

B.S., Sociology – Iowa State University, Ames, IA *1996 – 2000*

Minors: Child & Family Services, Family & Financial Services, Therapy & Counseling (Certified)

Pragmatic Marketing Certified – Level VI – Pragmatic Institute (Product Management & Marketing) *2016 – 2018*